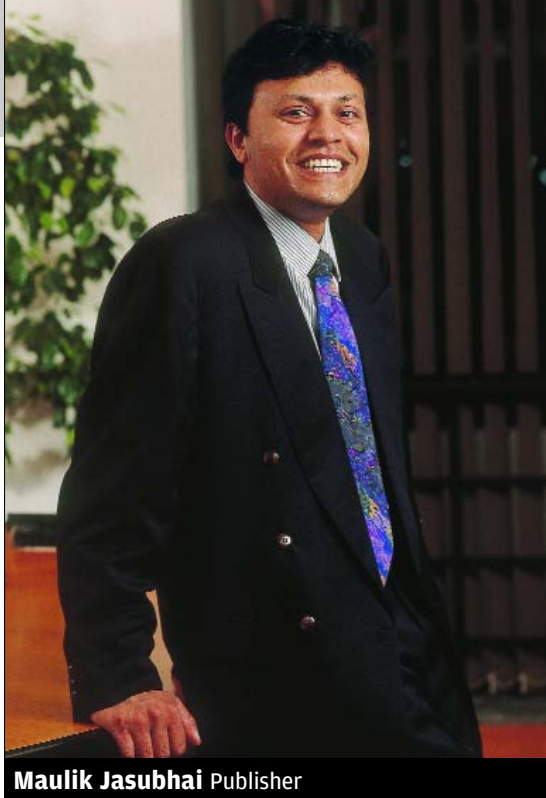




Maulik Jasubhai Publisher

Publisher's Note

The Great Indian Tech Journey

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XACTLY 366 DAYS AGO, while celebrating *Digit's* third anniversary, I hazarded to write in this column about how India is on the verge of that crucial inflexion point where we could take off into the next era of technology innovation and progress. At that point in time, to be honest, we could have gone either way.

I am happy to report that we have indeed broken the sound barrier, and are now zooming ahead into a new dimension, so to speak. Technology is fast being accepted as an integral part of our lives—both personal and professional—more than ever before.

Over the last four years, with each issue of *Digit*, the team here bet on how technology will change our lives; on how it will help us communicate better, utilise limited resources better, and even cut transaction costs to an affordable level.

We believe that, in our very small way, we helped India reach a stage where its citizens (or at least a certain section) are no longer technologically challenged. We are a nation of technology- and knowledge-hungry people, waiting to burst into the international scene. *Digit* recognises that, and this philosophy is reflected in each article we write, each product we review, and each column we opine in.

The sceptics would say that India is still an elephant, and that it cannot dance. That India is a nation of poor people, with little or insignificant demand for technology, despite

its billion-plus population. This may be true to a certain extent. No one can deny that more than half our population is poor, and can barely afford two meals a day.

However, if any one aspect of life can take them towards self-reliance, and later prosperity, it is technology. NIIT's Hole-in-the-Wall innovation, ITC's ambitious e-Chaupal project, and HP's Project Muskaan, are all examples of how our lives can be enriched by leveraging technology to generate employment, and create educational opportunities.

As *Digit* enters its fifth year, we reinforce our belief that technology adaptation is here to stay and to accelerate. The coming year would see greater emphasis on *Digit's* part to break new ground in technology communication. We have always innovated for our readers, and this year would no different. It is no coincidence that the year of India's technological inflexion point was also the year *Digit* saw the most growth in readership and mass acceptance.

We are proud and privileged to be a small part of The Great Indian Technology Journey, together with you.

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